United Against Cancer

November 1, 2026

Presented by

Team ALL IN



For those fighting, those who survived, and those we lost.

Cancer by the numbers

What every family in Canada should know



About 2 in 5 Canadians are expected to be diagnosed with cancer in their lifetime.

In 2026, that's an estimated **254,100 people** in Canada, nearly 700 every day.

Sources: Canadian Cancer Society, Cancer statistics (Canadian Cancer Statistics 2025: 42% lifetime probability). 2026 projection: Brenner et al., “Projected estimates of cancer in Canada in 2026”, CMAJ, April 2026.

About

64%

of Canadians survive at least five years after a cancer diagnosis.

So the question isn't only “will I survive?” It's “will my family's finances survive it?”

Source: Canadian Cancer Statistics 2021, Public Health Agency of Canada (about 64% five-year net survival; Canadian Cancer Statistics 2025 reports the same figure).

Nearly

$33,000

The average cost of cancer to a Canadian patient in out-of-pocket expenses and lost income.

- Prescription drugs
- Home care
- Travel and parking
- Assistive devices
- Family care
- Lost income

Source: Canadian Cancer Society, Canadian Cancer Statistics report, December 2024.

What Canadians fear

80% Nearly 80% of working-age Canadians worry they'd struggle to save for retirement after a cancer diagnosis.

66% 66% expect they'd have to take significant unpaid time off work.

28% 28% believe they would lose their job.

Source: Canadian Cancer Society and Angus Reid Institute survey, February 2025.

How prepared are we?

9%

of Canadians have critical illness insurance.



Each leaf is 1 in 100 people

32%

of Canadians have no emergency fund at all.



Each leaf is 1 in 100 people

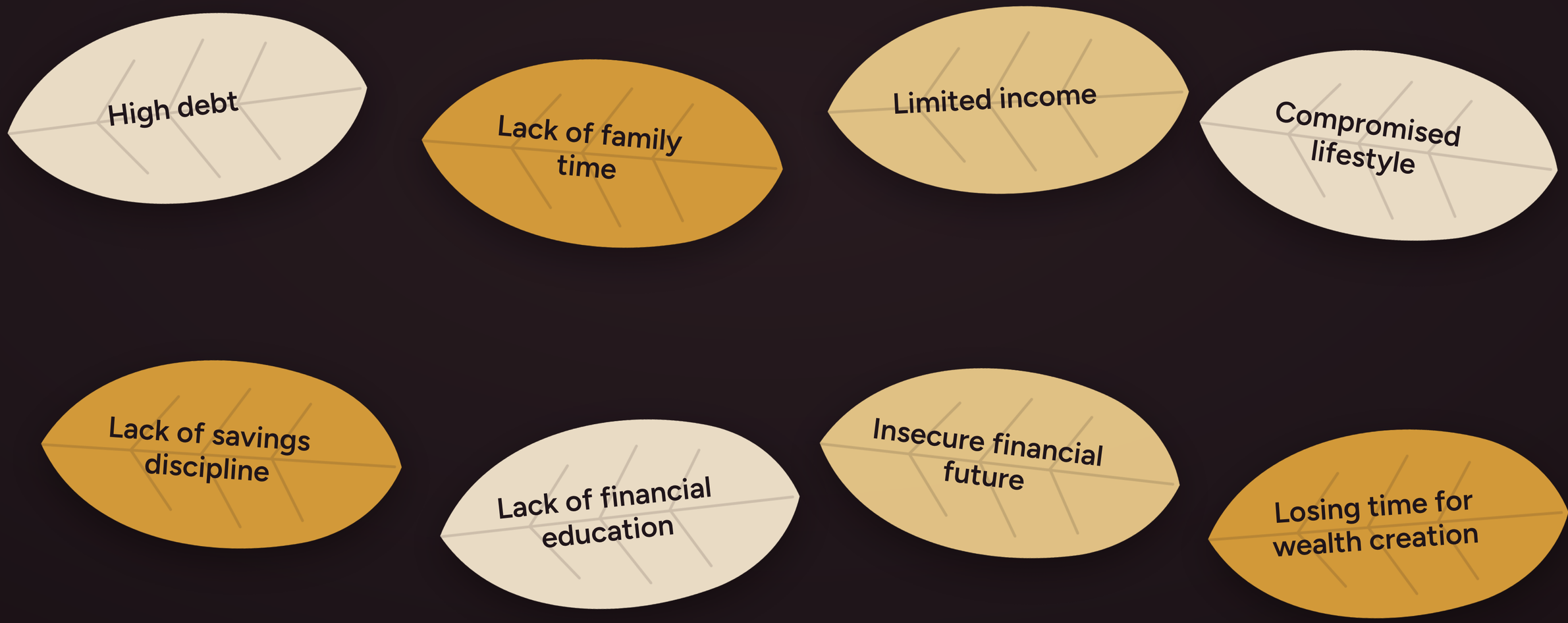
Sources: RBC Insurance poll conducted by Ipsos, 2,001 Canadians, August 2025. RBC Emergency Readiness Poll, July 2026.

Foresters Financial

Do you know exactly what would happen to your income if you couldn't work for six months?

Most families aren't unprepared because they don't care. They're unprepared because everyday life is already a fight.

The challenges families face every day



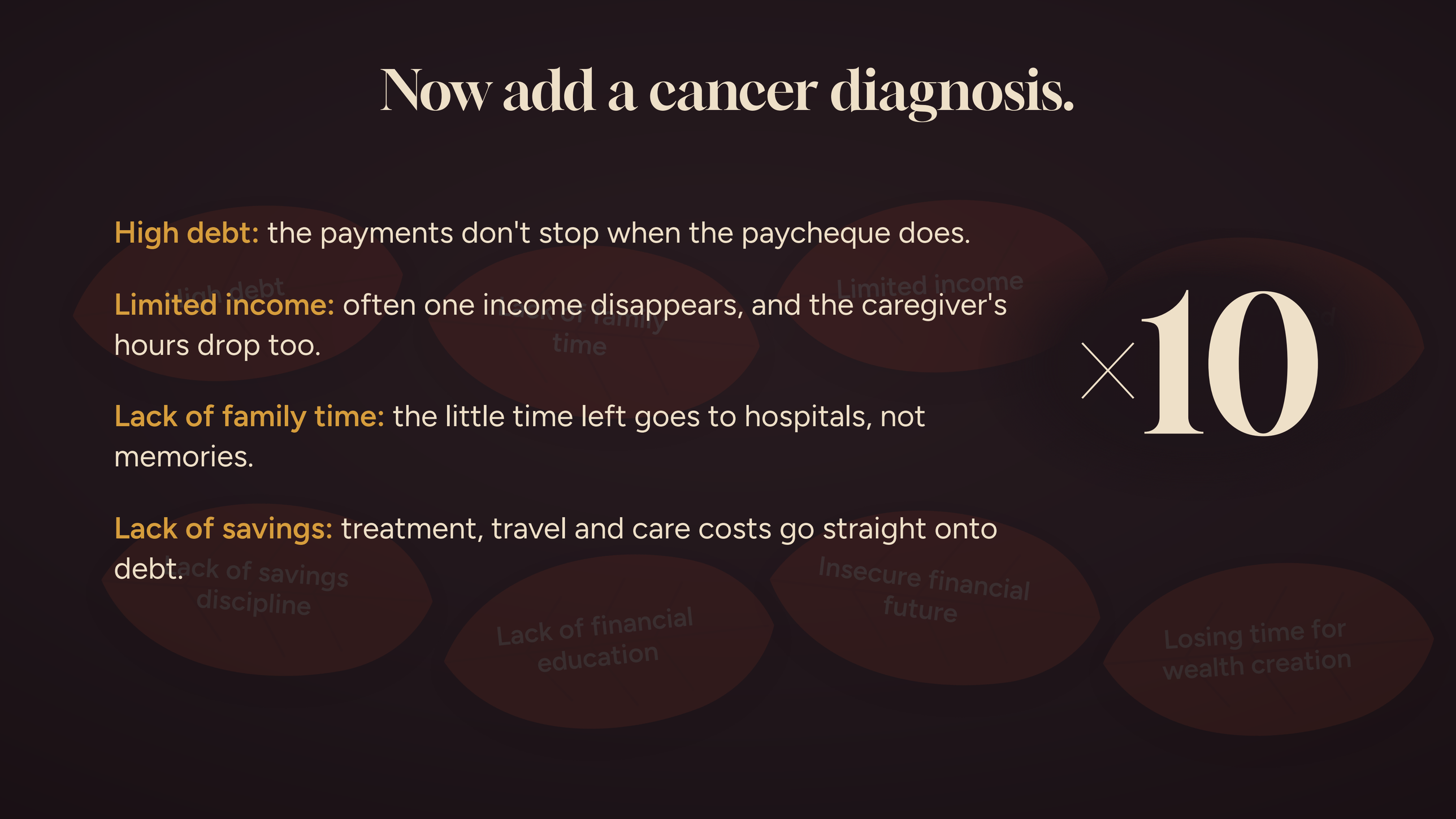
Now add a cancer diagnosis.

High debt: the payments don't stop when the paycheque does.

Limited income: often one income disappears, and the caregiver's hours drop too.

Lack of family time: the little time left goes to hospitals, not memories.

Lack of savings: treatment, travel and care costs go straight onto debt.



×10

A story from our community

Live

Same disease. Two different outcomes.

Unprepared

Steven Hodges



- Self-employed, wife and young child
- Stage 4 throat and mouth cancer, 40 rounds of radiation plus chemotherapy
- No disability insurance; his wife's plan didn't fully cover medication
- Lost two years of steady income
- About $125,000 in costs: emptied his RRSPs and TFSAs, took a second mortgage

Prepared

Sandra and Warren



- Married couple with an infant daughter
- Sandra was diagnosed with lymphoma
- They had critical illness insurance
- The coverage let Warren take care of Sandra and their daughter, and eased the financial and emotional strain

Steven's story: Canadian Cancer Society, February 2025. Sandra and Warren's story: Canada Life client story.

[OPTIONAL: replace or add a Foresters client story]

“

I didn't want to let my family down.

Steven Hodges

Steven had savings. But savings alone couldn't carry two years without income.



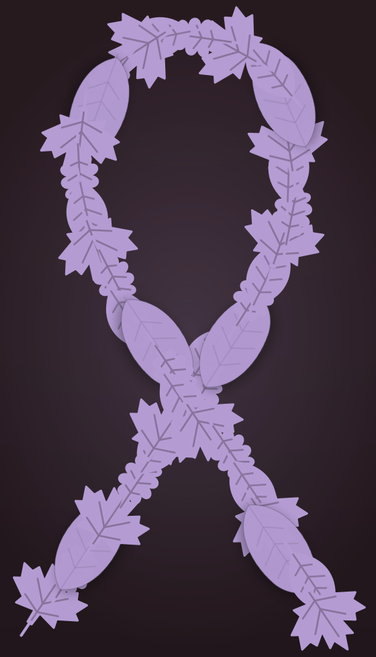
Savings habit



Protection

Build the money. Protect it so a crisis can't take it away. That's a decision you make while you're healthy.

This is a mission. No family in our community should face this unprepared.



Everyone in this room now knows something most families don't.
That's our shared responsibility.

So how does a family become the prepared family?



Let's find out.